

# Diego Leyton

Senior Software Engineer and Creative Technologist

[LinkedIn](#) · [Portfolio](#) · [Reference Letter](#) · [dleytons@gmail.com](mailto:dleytons@gmail.com) · +1(415) 2995023 · Concord, CA, USA

**Senior Software Engineer and Creative Technologist** with 14+ years of experience building interactive products across **games, AR/VR, and consumer applications**. I specialize in turning ambitious ideas into polished experiences by combining strong engineering, product thinking, and creativity.

At **Meta**, I served as an **Engineering Manager and Technical Lead** on Horizon Worlds, building large-scale social and multiplayer VR experiences. I am also the **founder of MarMilo**, a Unity-based family application that I have taken from concept to betavalidation with real users.

## CAREER SUMMARY

- **14+ years of experience** building interactive products across **games, AR/VR, education, and consumer applications**.
- **7 years at Meta (Facebook)**, serving as **Engineering Manager and Tech Lead** on Horizon Worlds, delivering **large-scale multiplayer VR experiences**.
- Previously **Lead Engineer at Meta Company (AR startup)**, developing **Augmented Reality collaboration technology**, following **5 years in the game industry** (DeNA, Atakama Labs) shipping mobile games worldwide on Google Play, the App Store, and Amazon Appstore.
- **5 years in the game industry** (DeNA, Atakama Labs), leading the development of mobile games released worldwide on Google Play, App Store and Amazon Store.
- **Founder of MarMilo**, leading **product strategy, UX, software engineering, and user research** for a Unity-based platform that helps families build positive habits through **positive reinforcement**.

## IMPACT SUMMARY

### Product Development

**Led and contributed** to multiple high-impact applications used by millions of users — including **Meta's Horizon Worlds** and several mobile games

### Engineering Excellence

**Drove a cross-team test coverage initiative (9 teams, ~90 engineers)**, raising automation **from 50% to 90%**, reducing regressions, and improving release stability.

### System Migration

As Engineering Manager at Meta, **led the migration of Creation Tools architecture**, enabling faster iteration and better user experiences and performance.

As Tech Lead at Meta, **led the organization-wide migration of the UI system**, improving maintainability and cross-platform consistency.

### AR Innovation

**Invented the smartphone-to-AR interaction technique**, later **patented and widely showcased** in product demos and investor presentations, which was instrumental in securing additional investor funding. **Winner of the AWE 2017 Best Presentation Award** for Augmented Reality.

## Architecture Design

Created the MVCB **architecture pattern, adopted across AR projects** for modularity and engine independence.

## Educational Technology

**Created personal learning tools** for my children that transformed daily routines — from understanding math to brushing teeth — into playful, self-motivated activities, reflecting my belief that technology can nurture curiosity and autonomy from an early age.

## EXPERIENCE

### MarMilo

Founder and creator of [MarMilo](#).

#### Founder & Software Engineer

May 2026 — Present

MarMilo · CA, USA

- Built a cross-platform family habit-building application in Unity, including separate Parents and Kids experiences.
- Designed and implemented a configurable reward system that adapts to each child's developmental needs.
- Developed the complete application architecture, cloud synchronization, content pipeline, and deployment process.
- Conducted beta validation with real families, collecting product feedback and iterating on UX and engagement.
- Led product vision, UX design, engineering, and release planning as a solo founder.

## Meta (Facebook)

Tech Lead / Engineering Manager in [Horizon Worlds](#).

### Senior Software Engineer & Tech Lead (Horizon Worlds)

Aug 2023 — Mar 2026

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Led performance tools team** to enable creators to evaluate and improve runtime efficiency across Horizon platforms.
- **Led a pillar-wide test coverage initiative across 9 teams (~90 engineers)**, increasing automated test coverage from 50% to 90%, resulting in a measurable reduction in regressions and higher release stability.

### Engineering Manager (Horizon Worlds Creation Tools)

Jan 2021 — Aug 2023

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Managed Horizon Worlds team (10+ engineers)**, providing [Creation Tools](#) to users so they can build and share their immersive experiences.
- **Led the migration of Horizon Worlds CreationTools architecture**, enabling faster iteration and better creator experiences.

### Senior Software Engineer / Tech Lead

Dec 2018 — Jan 2021

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Tech Lead** of the team building the **Creation Tools** of Horizon Worlds
- **Tech Lead building the VR UI library** for Horizon Worlds.
- Senior Software Engineer **building the first version of Horizon Worlds**.

## Meta Company (AR)

### Lead Engineer (Augmented Reality)

Dec 2016 — Sep 2018

Meta Company (AR) · San Mateo, CA, USA

- **Led Collaboration in Augmented Reality**: With this feature, users can simultaneously interact with holograms in the AR workspace.
- **Created the org widely used architecture pattern MVCB** based on MVC, to work with different game and graphical engines.
- **Meta Cloud Infrastructure (GoLang)**: Worked as a backend and frontend software engineer developing the Meta Cloud infrastructure and micro-services.
- **Inventor of the interaction with Smart Phones in Augmented Reality**. This is an intuitive way to grab content from a Smart Phone, just using the hands (patented). Videos: [Collaboration in AR](#) and [Importing 3D Models](#).
- **Winner of the best presentation for Augmented Reality Award** in AWE 2017, the largest AR+VR event in the world.
- **Managed the architecture improvement** of the Meta2 Workspace, a working environment for Augmented Reality.
- Part of the **SDK team**, implementing features as the calibration profile system for the Meta2 headset.

# DeNA Studios

Worked developing **video games as a Technical Lead Engineer**.

## Technical Lead Engineer

Jun 2015 — Dec 2016

DeNA Studios San Francisco · San Francisco, CA, USA

- **Technical Lead Engineer of [Deck Storm](#) (Unity 3D)**. This is a modern mobile game based on customizable collectible card game (CCCG), and released in Google Play and Apple AppStore.
- **Proposed and successfully implemented engineering quality standards**, reducing the amount of issues found by QA, and improving our game quality, robustness and user experience.

## Senior Software Engineer

Feb 2014 — Jun 2015

DeNA Studios Canada · Vancouver, BC, Canada

- **Designed the software architecture** used in most company games.
- Worked on [World of Thingies](#) (Unity3D). This mobile video game was released in Google Play, Apple AppStore and Amazon AppStore.

## Software Engineer → Lead Engineer → Project Manager

Jun 2011 — Feb 2014

Atakama Labs (DeNA Studios Santiago) · Santiago, Chile

- **Led [Dungeons and Dragons Arena of War](#) (Unity 3D) and [Galaxy Assault](#) (JavaScript)**, games released on Google Play and App Store.
- **Evangelized Unity 3D** adoption across teams through mentorship and training.
- Collaborated with DeNA San Francisco to enhance the company's internal framework (C++, Objective-C, Java, JS).
- Contributed to the Android port of [Zombie Farm](#) using the internal engine; **this title was a key factor in DeNA's acquisition of the company**.

## PERSONAL PROJECTS

### Educational Applications

Designed and developed multiple interactive learning applications used daily by my children to acquire core cognitive skills.

- [Math Learning App](#) enabling toddlers to understand additions through visual interactions.
- [Brushing Teeth App](#) using interactive virtual pets and rewards to guide children through proper hygiene routines.

### Interactive Experiences

- [Horizon Worlds Creation Tools & Scripting Tutorial](#) for the community, which was well received and featured as a must-see resource for beginners.
- [Haunted House](#) giving users a VR experience using Horizon Worlds.

SKILLS

Tech

- C#
- Unity 3D
- C++
- Java
- JavaScript
- React

Methods & Leadership

- Team Management
- Front End
- Agile Methodologies

Domains

- Augmented Reality
- Virtual Reality
- Game Development
- Educational Technologies

Quality & Tools

- Software Usability
- Git
- Phabricator

EDUCATION

|                                                                     |             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Master's Degree, Computer Science</b><br>University of Chile     | 2010 — 2013 |
| <b>Engineers' Degree, Computer Science</b><br>University of Chile   | 2008 — 2013 |
| <b>Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science</b><br>University of Chile   | 2005 — 2008 |
| <b>Outstanding Student, Computer Science</b><br>University of Chile | 2009 — 2009 |

PUBLICATIONS

- Leyton, D.; Pino, J.A.; Ochoa, S.F., "EBTAM: technology acceptance in e-Business environments", Information Systems and e-Business Management, 01 May. 2015.  
DOI: 10.1007/s10257-014-0255-2
- Leyton, D.; Pino, J.A.; Ochoa, S.F., "Modeling Technology Acceptance in E-Business Environments", e-Business Engineering (ICEBE), 2013 IEEE 10th International Conference on Coventry, UK, pp.90, 97, 11-13 Sept. 2013.  
DOI: 10.1109/ICEBE.2013.14

LANGUAGES

- English — Fluent (written and spoken)
- Spanish — Native